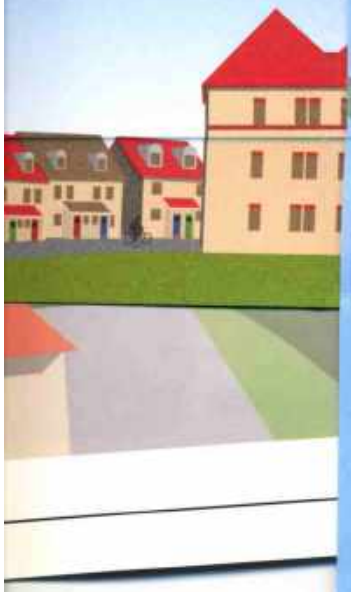


Thamesmead vision

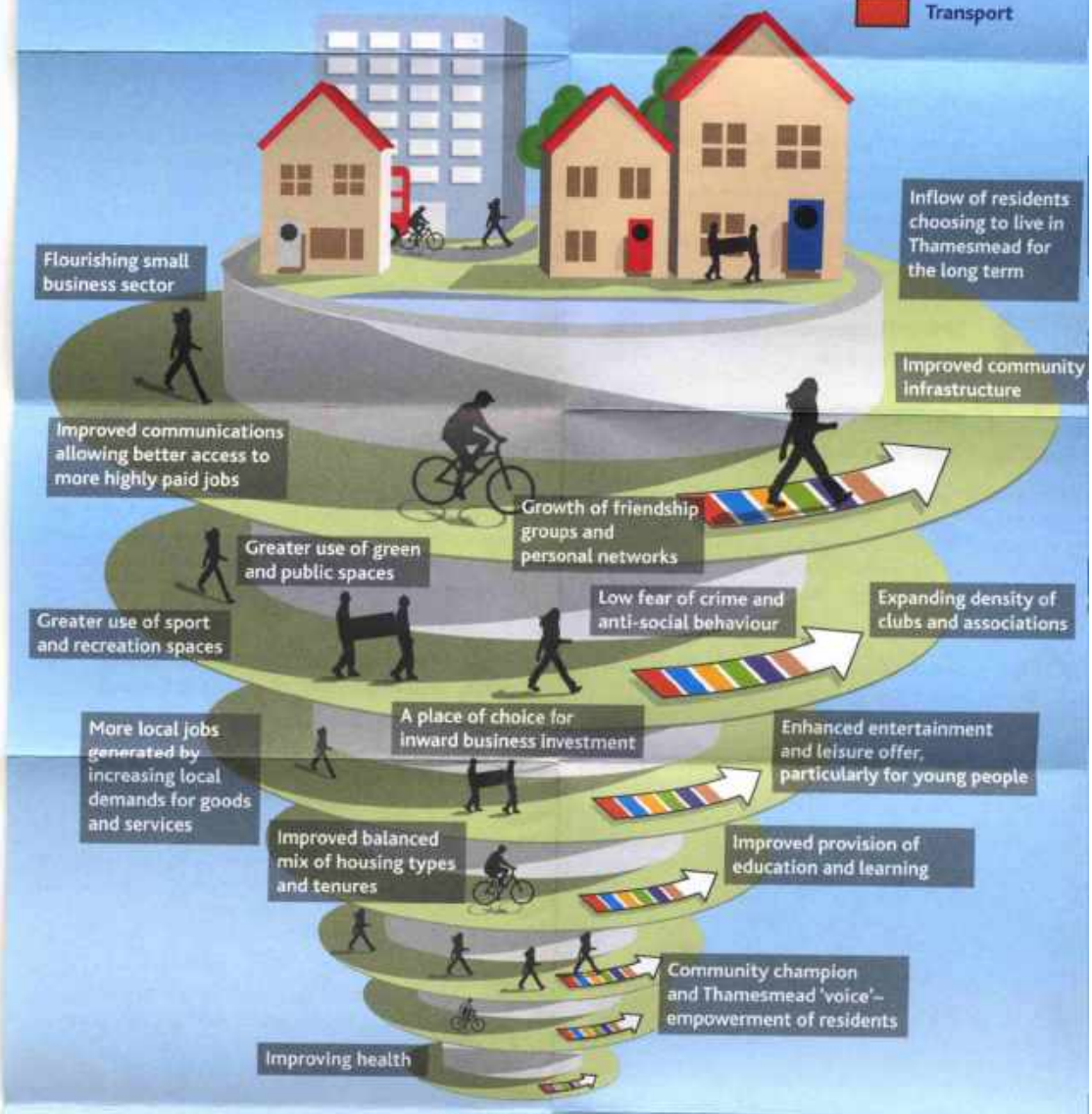
The **Thamesmead vision** looks at how Thamesmead is at an important crossroads in its history. Taking the right path could see the area prosper once again, while a step in the wrong direction would mean decline.

Thamesmead spiral

The **Thamesmead spiral** outlines ten core themes clearly showing what steps must be taken if Thamesmead is to become an attractive, welcoming community where people want to live and work.

6 big fixes:

- Housing
- Town centre
- Green spaces
- Employment
- River front
- Transport



Thamesmead today

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Unleashing personal potential

With more skilled jobs available locally, residents must have access to first class learning and training facilities. Local residents should enjoy the rewards of a thriving local economy and this can only happen if they have the skills to contribute.



Currently, 33% of residents aged 16-74 have no qualifications.

Generating a dynamic local economy

Better transport connections will help encourage more companies to set up in the area. These new businesses will bring with them the opportunity for more highly skilled, highly paid local jobs. And, as stronger businesses arrive in Thamesmead the cycle will continue and a healthy local economy will begin to take shape.



Developing local business parks will deliver local job opportunities.

Caring for the community

Supporting and encouraging a healthier lifestyle has benefits for individuals and the community as a whole – it is essential if Thamesmead is to flourish. A new health centre, healthy eating and exercise plans, easy access to parks and cycle lanes are all ways to help look after the health and happiness of residents.



Age for age health of residents is poor compared to London and national averages.

Connecting Thamesmead

A transport infrastructure with easy access to, from and within Thamesmead will not only increase employment prospects for residents but will also improve their recreation and leisure time. The continued development of Crossrail, Docklands Light Railway and North Bexley Transit would open Thamesmead to a wider audience bringing new people to the area.



37% of Thamesmead households do not own a car.

Unlocking Thamesmead

Thamesmead's many parks and waterways provide a great opportunity within London to build an attractive and environmentally friendly neighbourhood. By renovating tow-paths and opening up access to the canals and lakes, the area can once again be used for canoeing, sailing and fishing.



Waterways, green spaces and tree planting programmes provide an outstanding natural environment.

Building quality neighbourhoods

There are many ways of building better quality neighbourhoods including practical steps such as external redecoration and refurbishment, regenerating run-down areas and keeping roads and signage free from rubbish and graffiti. Community halls and centres can be improved, particularly with a view to providing better resources for young people and residents having easy access to a mix of services and facilities.



Tavy Bridge's regeneration will help tackle crime and anti-social behaviour.

Rebranding Thamesmead

Part of Thamesmead's problems today is that many do not see the good in the area concentrating only on the problems. However, Thamesmead has the potential to become a great place to live and work. A local radio station, newspaper, local events and a promotional plan will all help get the message out that Thamesmead is changing.



The annual Trust Thamesmead Festival draws thousands of visitors to the area.

Creating a vibrant Town Centre

A community cannot succeed if it has no heart and Thamesmead's Town Centre must have the structure to play a central role in residents' lives. It should offer a mix of retail, leisure and social facilities to all – an attractive and inviting town centre helps create a real sense of belonging. As the town centre grows so too will the numbers of people visiting it.



By 2016 the Town Centre could attract 5 million annual shopping visits.

Championing the community

As the upward spiral continues and the Thamesmead community grows, residents must have an effective platform to communicate their opinions. Stakeholders must work together to form a partnership whose goal is to put the needs of Thamesmead's residents first.



Thamesmead's population has increased from 27,000 to around 34,000 in five years. This figure will continue to grow.

Balancing the community

Thamesmead still has a significant proportion of its population living in social rented housing. For its long term future Thamesmead must encourage more balanced neighbourhoods with a mix of homes, household types and tenures. Successful, sustainable neighbourhoods are made up of many different types of people and resources.



41% of households in Thamesmead live in social rented housing compared to the London average of 26%.



A new vision for Thamesmead

Towards 2016

It has been nearly forty years since the first family arrived to live in Thamesmead and in that time the area has seen some sweeping changes. It now faces serious social challenges for the future